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Report: THE IMPACT OF LINKEDIN PROFESSIONALISM ON IT UNDERGRADUATE STUDENTS



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ABSTRACT

This study looks at the connection between LinkedIn professionalism. Perceived career opportunities among IT undergraduate students in Sri Lanka. It focuses on four aspects of LinkedIn professionalism: profile management, sharing achievements and activities, professional networking and personal branding. Perceived career opportunities is the variable and means how respondents think about LinkedIn's usefulness for finding internships, jobs, IT projects, professional contacts and other career possibilities. The topic matters because students often start building an identity before they have much full-time work experience and LinkedIn professionalism gives them a place to share their skills, projects, interests and connections.

The study uses a cross-sectional survey design and looks at 76 survey responses. The survey was on Google Forms. It was shared through student WhatsApp groups, academic channels, direct peer messages and LinkedIn posts. Convenience sampling with peer sharing was used. The questionnaire had questions on LinkedIn-use questions and 25 core statements scored on a five-point Likert scale. IBM SPSS Statistics was used for statistics, composite scoring, Cronbach's alpha, Pearson correlation, multiple linear regression, one-way ANOVA and a chi-square test.

Overall, the findings suggest that personal branding and professional networking are especially important for perceived career opportunities, in this sample but the cross-sectional self-report design cannot prove causality or confirm employment outcomes.

1. INTRODUCTION

Digital platforms have changed the way people show themselves professionally, stay in touch with others and find out about jobs. LinkedIn is built for networking. It lets users list their education, skills, projects, certifications, interests and work history. For IT undergraduates this can be very helpful. The tech industry has different roles and the skills needed are always changing. Students might want to start building connections before they finish their studies.

Students can use LinkedIn to share projects from university, show off their abilities, follow companies in the tech world, take part in professional conversations and connect with people who work in fields they care about. These actions might help students learn about internships, entry-level jobs, mentoring, events and project chances. Just having a LinkedIn account does not mean a student is using it in a professional way. A profile might be missing details. Posts might not clearly show a person’s skills. Having many connections does not always mean those connections are strong or useful.

This report looks at four parts of LinkedIn professionalism: profile management, sharing achievements and activities, professional networking and personal branding. These parts. Show different kinds of behavior. Profile management is about how correctly a person presents their background. Achievement sharing is about making learning and project work visible. Networking is about building relationships with people in the fields. Personal branding is about showing a real professional identity. The main outcome being measured is perceived career opportunities, which reflects how students feel about their chances not job offers or confirmed employment.

The study wants to explore how these four parts are linked to how students see their career opportunities. The results could help students think carefully about how they use LinkedIn. It might also give universities ideas for career support. The report looks at 76 responses. That's the number of people the lecturer said was enough for this assignment. The findings should be seen as a signal, about this group not as proof that using LinkedIn in ways leads directly to career success.

1.1 Research Problem

LinkedIn is a professional platform. Students sometimes wonder which actions open doors to jobs. Managing profile posting achievements, building networks and shaping a brand can all help, but they may not all matter equally. This research looks at each of these actions, on its own and together using statistics to see how they link to the chances of finding a job.

1.2 Aim and Objectives

The goal is to look at how professional someone appears on the LinkedIn platform and how it affects how students think about their career chances.

- Talk about the people who took part in the study and how they use LinkedIn.
- Check the scores for five groups of questions and make sure they are reliable.
- Look at how the four different parts of professionalism relate to how students see their career chances.
- See how all four parts and on their own affect career chances using a type of math test called multiple regression.
- Check if the career chance scores are different, for people who use LinkedIn more or less.
- Give the square test result and make sure to mention the rules that need to be followed for that test.

1.3 Research Questionnaire

The following reproduces the question wording and response options in the questionnaire PDF supplied for review. The Google Forms introduction/consent text was not included in that PDF.

General Questions

1. What is your age group?

- Under 18
- 18–20
- 21–23
- 24–26
- Above 26

2. What is your gender?

- Male
- Female
- Prefer not to say

3. What is your current year of study?

- 1st Year
- 2nd Year
- 3rd Year
- 4th Year
- Other

4. What is your main area of study in IT?

- Computer Science
- Software Engineering
- Information Systems
- Information Technology
- Cybersecurity / Networking
- Data Science / Artificial Intelligence

5. Do you currently have an active LinkedIn account?

- Yes
- No

6. How frequently do you use LinkedIn?

- Daily
- Several times a week
- Once a week
- Occasionally
- Rarely

7. How long have you been using LinkedIn?

- Less than 6 months
- 6 months–1 year
- 1–2 years
- More than 2 years
- I recently created my account

8. How often do you update your LinkedIn profile?

- Very frequently
- Frequently
- Sometimes
- Rarely
- Never

9. Have you shared any university-related activity on LinkedIn?

- Yes
- No

10. Have you ever received a professional opportunity through LinkedIn?

- Yes
- No
- Not sure

Core Scale Response Options

1 = Strongly Disagree; 2 = Disagree; 3 = Neutral; 4 = Agree; 5 = Strongly Agree.

LinkedIn Profile Management

1. I keep my LinkedIn profile updated with my current IT education, skills, and experiences.
2. I include my IT-related skills, certifications, courses, and qualifications on my LinkedIn profile.
3. I maintain professional profile photo, headline, and About section on LinkedIn.
4. I regularly review my LinkedIn profile to improve my professional presentation.
5. My LinkedIn profile accurately represents my current knowledge, skills, and abilities.

Achievement & Activity Sharing

6. I share my IT-related university projects or coursework on LinkedIn.
7. I share my participation in IT workshops, seminars, hackathons, conferences, or technology events on LinkedIn.
8. I share IT-related certificates, completed courses, and academic achievements on LinkedIn.
9. I share IT-related extracurricular activities, competitions, volunteering, or projects that contribute to my professional development.
10. I use LinkedIn to showcase my IT skills and experiences to a professional audience.

Professional Networking

11. I connect with professionals in my field through LinkedIn.
12. I follow companies, technology organizations, and industry professionals related to my career interests.
13. I use LinkedIn to build professional relationships with people working in the IT industry.
14. I engage with IT-related posts and content shared by professionals and technology organizations.
15. I use LinkedIn to expand my professional network beyond my university.

Personal Branding

16. I use LinkedIn to present myself as an IT professional.
17. I use LinkedIn to highlight my IT skills, strengths, and areas of interest.
18. I make an effort to create a positive professional image through my LinkedIn profile and activities.
19. I use LinkedIn to communicate my IT knowledge, experiences, and achievements to others.
20. I believe my LinkedIn presence helps others understand my professional interests and capabilities.

Career Opportunities

21. LinkedIn helps me discover internship opportunities.
22. LinkedIn helps me discover job opportunities related to my field of study.
23. A professional LinkedIn profile can increase my chances of being noticed by IT employers or recruiters.
24. LinkedIn can help me find IT-related opportunities such as projects, collaborations, competitions, or professional events.
25. I believe maintaining a professional LinkedIn presence can improve my future career opportunities in the IT industry.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

LinkedIn brings together how people present themselves online, connect with others professionally and grow in their careers. Studies have looked at how LinkedIn affects people's expectations for career success, how it helps students build their careers and what kind of impressions others get from their profiles. The research shows that LinkedIn is more than a place to store contacts or create a profile. It also shows that the value of LinkedIn changes based on how users act and how we define what counts as a career outcome.

2.1 LinkedIn and Career Outcome Expectations

Research on LinkedIn use and career expectations is directly relevant to this study because the main focus is on respondents' expectations and perceptions about career opportunities, not on jobs that are already secured. This research helps us see whether professional use of LinkedIn is linked to how students think about their chances without assuming that using LinkedIn will automatically bring a job.

LinkedIn can be a career-development tool for STEM students. Many students recognize the value of LinkedIn. I still need help building and using professional networks. This is especially true for IT undergraduates, who can benefit from more than a LinkedIn profile by learning how to share their skills and build professional relationships.

2.2 Profile Management and Professional Self-Presentation

Profile management means keeping education, skills, projects, qualifications and other work details up to date clear and correctly. Profile management also ensures that a profile is accurate and easy to read. A profile can shape the impression that a recruiter or professional contact receives. However, profile information must be read carefully: a polished profile alone does not prove ability. Guarantee a job.

For students, keeping a profile can help show growing experience and interests. The link between profile and perceived career opportunities may overlap with branding because both involve how a student presents their professional identity. This study therefore tests profile management by assuming it has a unique effect.

2.3 Achievement and Activity Sharing

Achievement and activity sharing means talking about academic and professional activities. These activities can be projects, certificates, workshops, hackathons and courses that have been finished. Sharing this kind of information can make a student's learning more obvious outside of the classroom. Posts tend to be easier to understand when they explain the situation of the project, what the student did, the tools that were used and what was learned of just showing off an achievement.

Still posting often is not the way to grow professionally and students feel different about sharing things publicly. Posting often does not mean that someone is not skilled. This idea is seen as something that people report themselves not as a way to measure how good someone is, at skills.

2.4 Professional Networking

Professional networking means creating and keeping relationships with people who can offer help, knowledge or discussions about jobs. On LinkedIn this can mean connecting with people in IT following companies

commenting on posts and taking part in job related talks. The quality and type of connections can be more important than having a lot of connections.

Students might see the importance of LinkedIn for their career growth. I still need help in joining professional groups. Because of this professional networking is used as a factor in this study.

2.5 Personal Branding

Personal branding is about how people share who they are professionally. Their interests, what they're good at and what they believe in. With others. On LinkedIn this shows up in your headline, the section of what you write about your projects, the skills you list and how everything matches with what you do online. It's not about putting things out there. You also need to think about who's seeing it and how it comes across.

For students in IT who're still in school personal branding helps show real interests and skills that are still growing. They don't have a lot of job experience yet. This is a chance to be honest and clear about what they're learning and working on. It's better to be truthful than to overstate what you can do.

This study checks if people who say they do branding well also feel they have better chances for career opportunities. It looks at how personal branding efforts connect to how hopeful or confident people feel about their jobs.

2.6 Research Gap

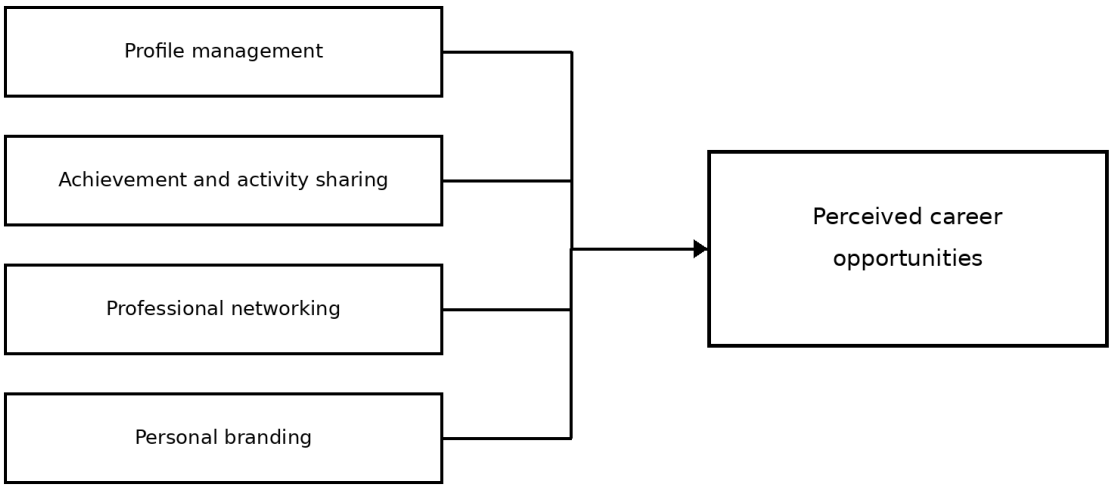
Existing research looks at LinkedIn and job goals, student career growth online profile reviews and personal image. How profile management showing accomplishments connecting with others and personal branding relate to each other might be different, in different groups. This study tries to answer that real world question by looking at the four areas together and checking both how they connect with each other and how each one stands on its own in a multiple regression model.

3. CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK AND HYPOTHESES

The conceptual framework proposes that each of the four dimensions of LinkedIn professionalism may be positively associated with perceived career opportunities.

Independent variable	Proposed dependent variable
LinkedIn profile management	Perceived career opportunities
Achievement and activity sharing	Perceived career opportunities
Professional networking	Perceived career opportunities
Personal branding	Perceived career opportunities

Figure 1. Conceptual framework linking the four LinkedIn professionalism dimensions to perceived career opportunities.



- H1: LinkedIn profile management is clearly linked to perceived career opportunities.
- H2: Sharing achievements and activities is clearly linked to perceived career opportunities.
- H3: Professional networking is clearly linked to perceived career opportunities.
- H4: Personal branding is clearly linked to perceived career opportunities.

4. VARIABLES

4.1 Independent Variables

Profile management is keeping information accurate and easy to read. Achievement and activity sharing means telling others about projects, qualifications, workshops and learning experiences. Professional networking is where building professional connections and talking to people and organizations in the IT field. Personal branding shows a real professional identity through profile content and activity. Maintaining branding, with honest posts and consistent style.

4.2 Dependent Variable

LinkedIn is a platform that helps people see if they can find internships, jobs, IT projects, professional connections and other career chances. It looks at what people think, not what actually happens in terms of getting hired or recruited.

5. METHODOLOGY

5.1 Research Design

The study is quantitative and cross-sectional using inferential statistics. The design was chosen to measure variables, test hypotheses and examine the relationships between the way IT undergraduates use LinkedIn and the perceived career development opportunities that IT undergraduates feel.

Data were collected at a point in time through a structured online survey. The design can identify patterns and associations. It cannot establish cause and effect.

5.2 Target Population and Sampling Method

The target population consisted of IT undergraduate students in Sri Lanka. These IT undergraduate students were studying Software Engineering, Information Systems, Computer Science, Cyber Security and Data Science/Artificial Intelligence at higher-education institutions, including NIBM. Because of time constraints and practical considerations using convenience sampling with peer sharing. The final dataset contains 76 responses. The module, which is briefly described in the supplied methodology document recommends a sample of least 50, for this coursework and the lecturer has confirmed that N = 76 is acceptable.

5.3 Questionnaire and Likert Scale Design

Google Forms questionnaire that consisted of six parts. The first part gathered background and demographic details such as age, gender, the year of study and the primary IT specialization. The second part explored LinkedIn usage asking about how often users logged in, how they had an account, how often they updated their profile and whether they had ever landed a job through LinkedIn. The third part offered 25 core statements that were scored on a five-point Likert scale, where 1 meant Disagree and 5 meant Strongly Agree.

Grouped the 25 statements into five variables and each variable contained five items. The variables were management, achievement and activity sharing, professional networking, personal branding and perceived career opportunities.

For each variable I calculated a score by averaging the five items keeping the original 1 to 5 scale.

The exact wording of each question can be found in Appendix A, taken from the Google Forms questionnaire. This report does not repeat those words.

5.4 Survey Distribution

The survey was. Hosted on Google Forms so that students could access it easily from their mobile phones or laptops. The link was shared in student WhatsApp groups, communication channels, direct messages between peers and also posted on LinkedIn. As stated in the methodology document Google Forms was set up to accept one response, per user to avoid duplicate entries. Once the responses were collected the data were downloaded in CSV format for analysis.

5.5 Sample Characteristics and Data Quality

The survey was. Hosted on Google Forms so that it could be accessed using mobile phones and laptops. The link was shared through student WhatsApp groups, channels direct messages to peers and LinkedIn posts. According to the provided methodology document Google Forms was set up to allow one response per user to prevent duplicate submissions. After the data collection was complete the information was exported in CSV format for analysis.

The final sample included 76 respondents, which is 54 male respondents making up 71.1% of the total and 22 female respondents making up 28.9%. Most of the participants were in their year at 51.3% or in their first year at 27.6%. The age group of the respondents was mostly between 18 and 23 years old. Software Engineering was very common with 43.4% of the respondents. The methodology confirms that all 76 responses were complete and that there were no missing data points across the 25 Likert-scale items.

These sample characteristics describe the group that took part in the survey. They should not be automatically applied to all IT undergraduates, in Sri Lanka.

5.6 Pilot Testing

Before the survey rollout I organized a small pilot test with about 10 to 15 IT students. The methodology document supplied to us says that the pilot was used to estimate how long the survey would take, three to five minutes. The pilot also checked if the survey questions were clear and easy to understand. The feedback from the pilot was very positive. A few minor wording adjustments were made for clarity.

5.7 Data Analysis

The data was looked at using IBM SPSS Statistics. Numbers were used to show what the people who answered the questions were like and what their scores were. Cronbach's alpha was used to check how consistent the answers were. Pearson correlation was used to see how two things were connected in a line. Multiple linear regression showed how each of the four parts of professionalism was connected to the chances of getting a job when other parts were taken into account. One-way ANOVA compared the chances of getting a job between people who used LinkedIn for different amounts of time. A square test checked one specific link between categories. The results were considered important when the chance of getting the result by accident was, than five percent.

6. RESULTS

6.1 Respondent Profile

The largest age group was 21–23 years making up 51.3% of the sample. Second-year students made up 51.3% of the sample while first-year students made up 27.6%. Software Engineering was the frequently reported specialization, at 43.4%. Most respondents had a LinkedIn account with 96.1% reporting this. The common reported usage frequency for LinkedIn was several times a week 26.3%, followed by daily use at 25.0%. The sample included 54 respondents, 71.1% and 22 female respondents 28.9%.

6.2 Descriptive Statistics

The five composite means ranged from 3.1605 for achievement and activity sharing to 3.5316 for perceived career opportunities. Professional networking had a mean of 3.5026 personal branding had a mean of 3.4026 and profile management had a mean of 3.3289. These averages suggest positive responses overall although respondents differed in their reported levels of professional LinkedIn use.

Table B1. Composite descriptive statistics

Composite variable	N	Mean	Std. deviation	Minimum	Maximum
Profile management	76	3.3289	1.06318	1.00	5.00
Achievement and activity sharing	76	3.1605	1.06484	1.00	5.00
Professional networking	76	3.5026	0.99089	1.00	5.00
Personal branding	76	3.4026	1.04179	1.00	5.00
Perceived career opportunities	76	3.5316	0.97792	1.00	5.00

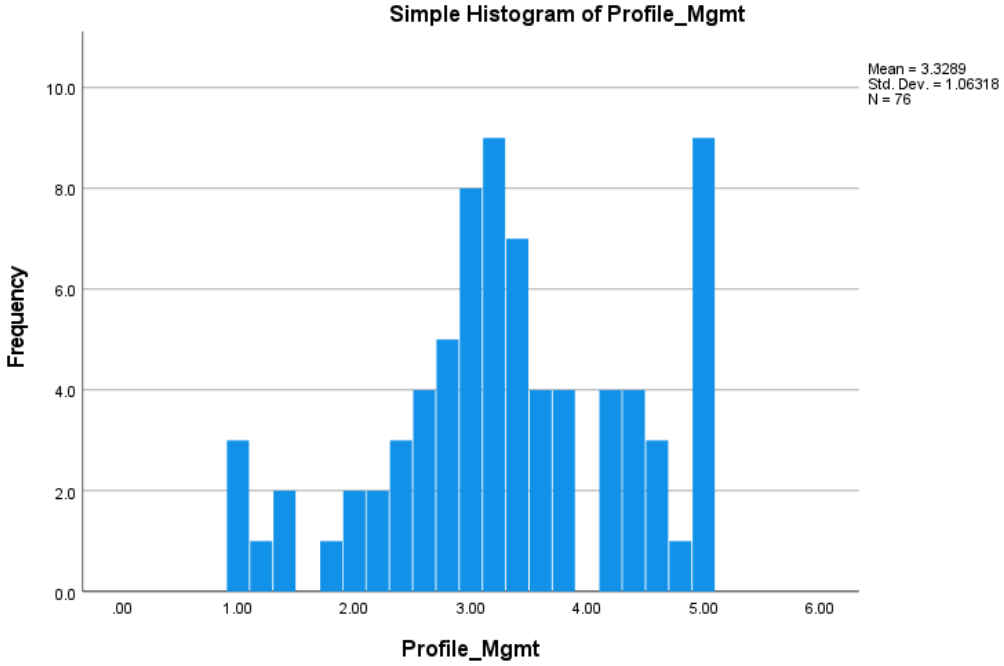


Figure B1. Histogram of the Profile Management composite score.



Figure B2. Histogram of the Achievement and Activity Sharing composite score.

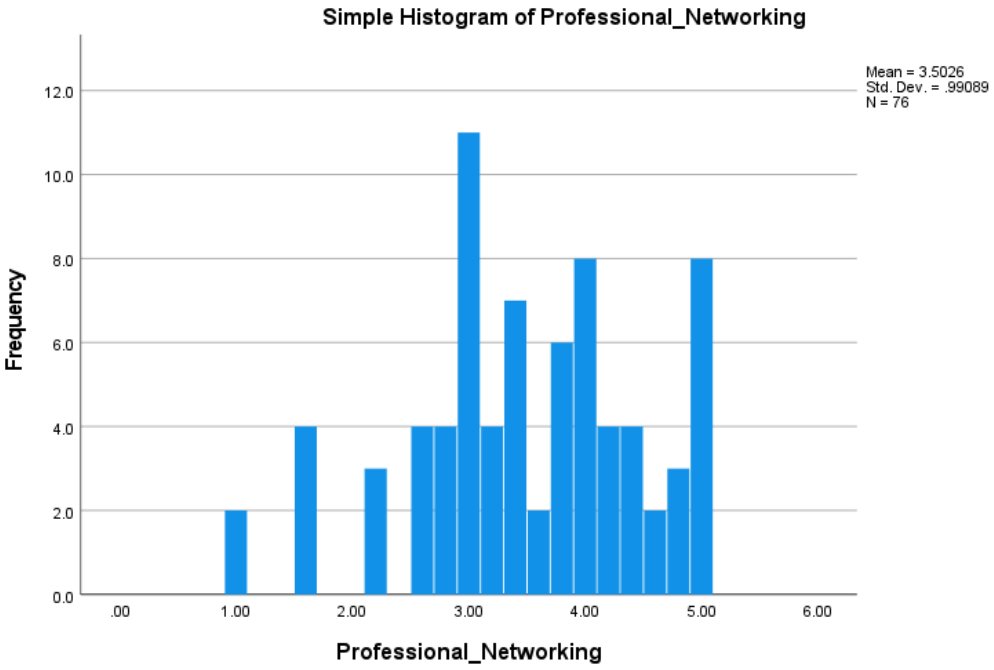


Figure B3. Histogram of the Professional Networking composite score.

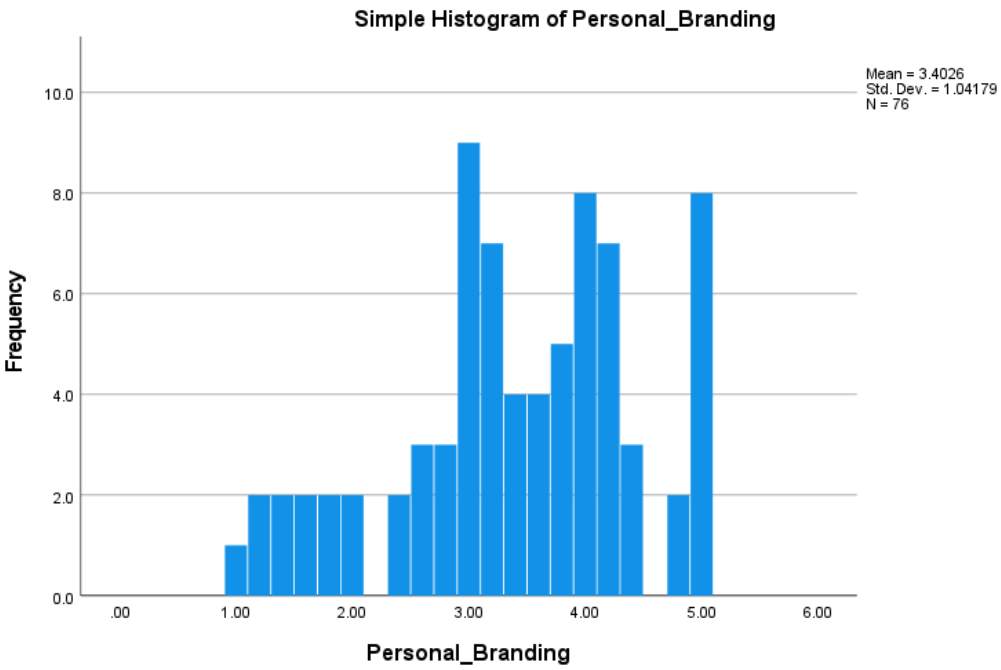


Figure B4. Histogram of the Personal Branding composite score.

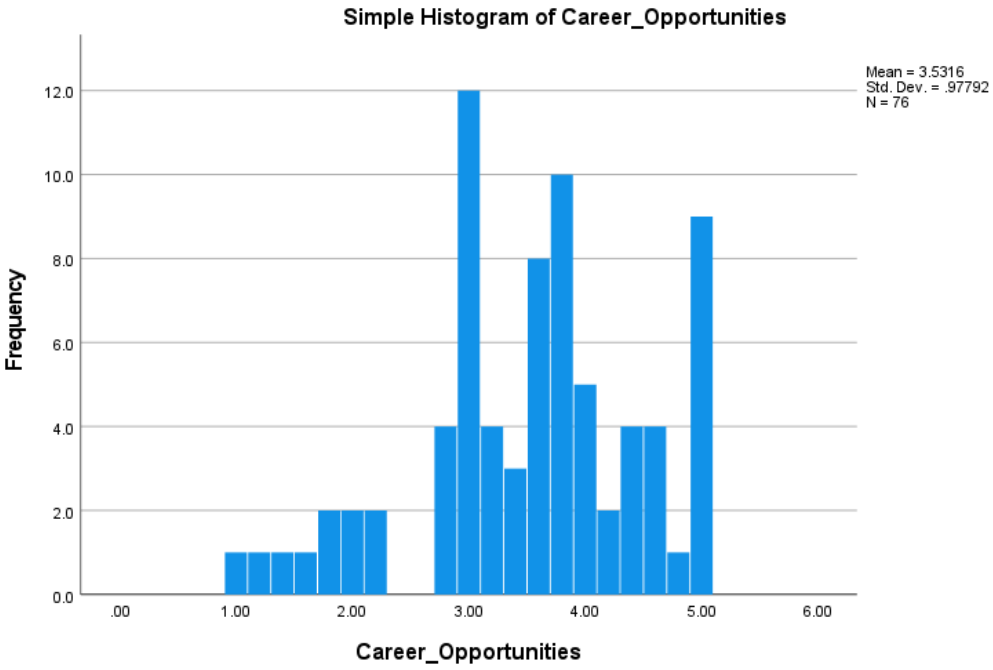


Figure B5. Histogram of the Perceived Career Opportunities composite score.

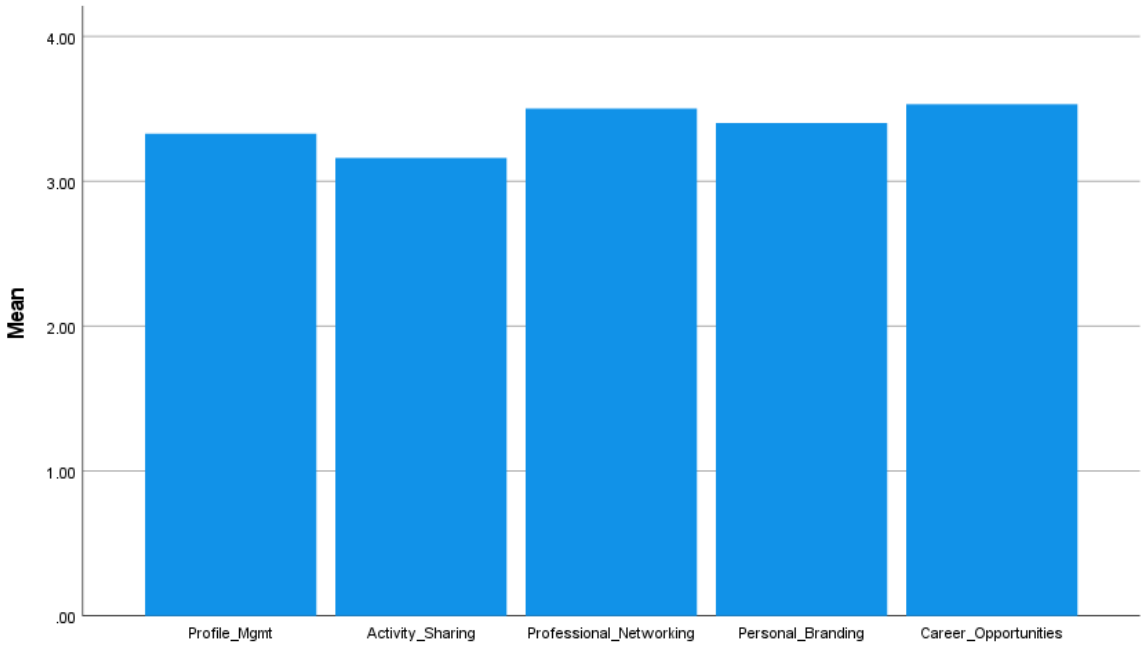


Figure B6. Comparison of the five composite means.

6.3 Reliability Analysis

Cronbach's alpha values ranged from.904 to.935 across the five scales. That means the items within each scale are much in line with one another. The numbers are high, which suggests the scales are reliable... Reliability doesn't mean everything is valid. Just because the questions agree with each other doesn't mean they're measuring what they're supposed to. So, it's important to look at the wording of the questionnaire and how the constructs are defined. That helps make sure the results make sense in terms.

Table B2. Internal consistency

Scale	Items	Cronbach's alpha
Profile management	5	.915
Achievement and activity sharing	5	.910
Professional networking	5	.904
Personal branding	5	.935
Perceived career opportunities	5	.905

6.4 Correlation Analysis

Perceived career opportunities were positively linked to branding (r =.757) professional networking (r =.711) achievement and activity sharing (r =.614) and profile management (r =.547). People who scored higher on these areas also reported perceived career opportunities. Correlation does not mean one causes the other. Also the predictor variables were connected to each other which makes it hard to say exactly what drives what.

Table B3. Pearson correlations with perceived career opportunities

Independent variable	Pearson r	Significance
Profile management	.547	$p < .001$
Achievement and activity sharing	.614	$p < .001$
Professional networking	.711	$p < .001$
Personal branding	.757	$p < .001$

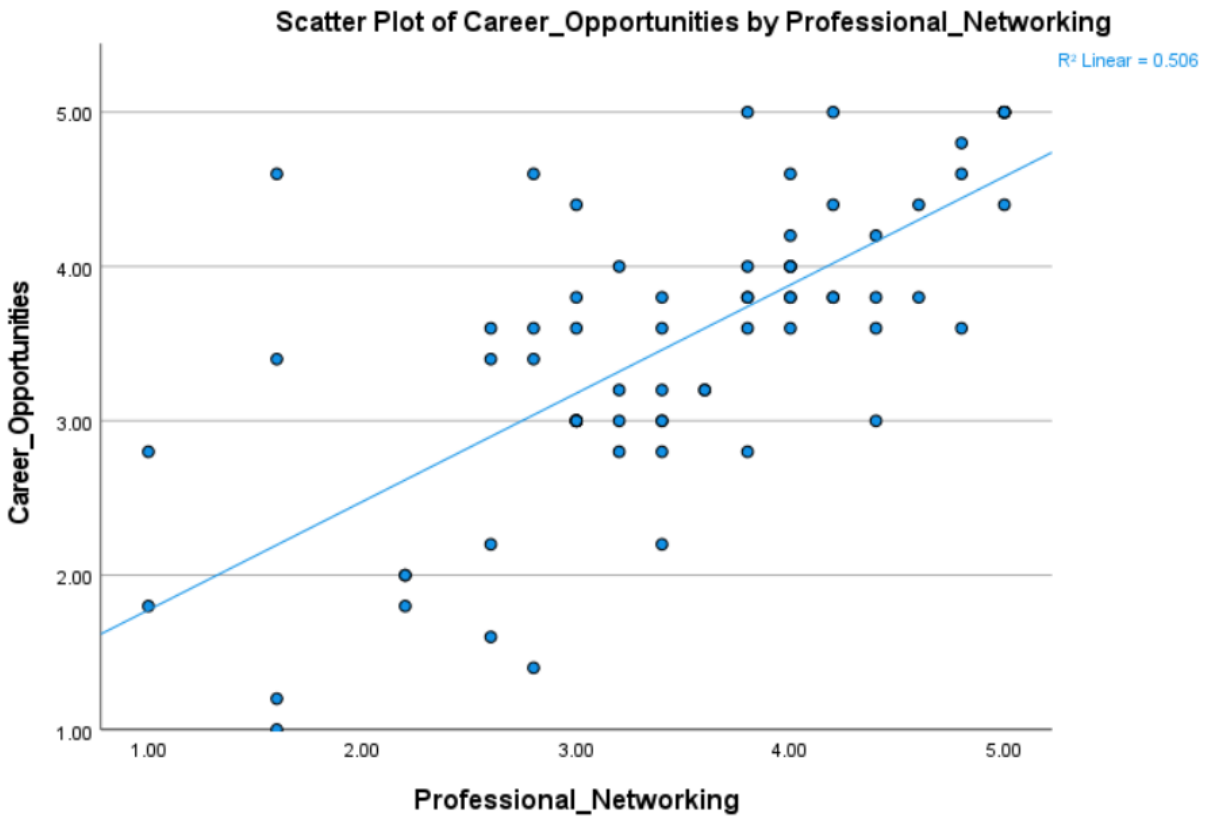


Figure B9. Scatterplot of Professional Networking and Perceived Career Opportunities.

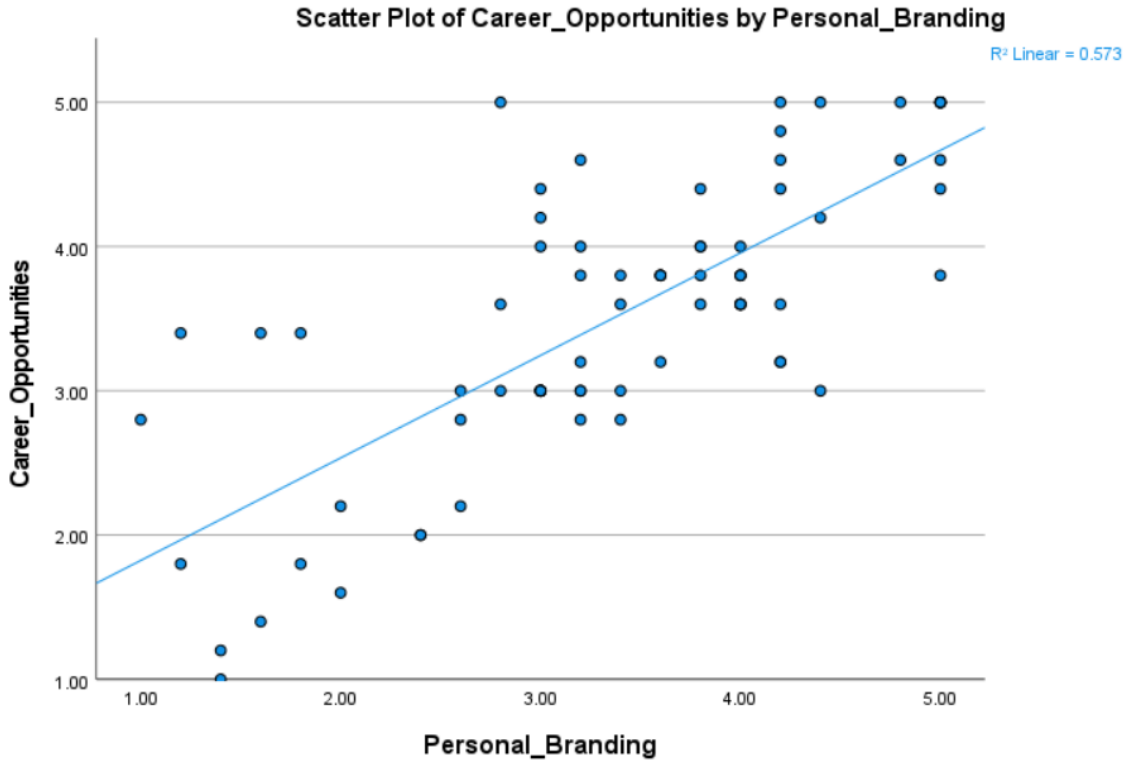


Figure B10. Scatterplot of Personal Branding and Perceived Career Opportunities.

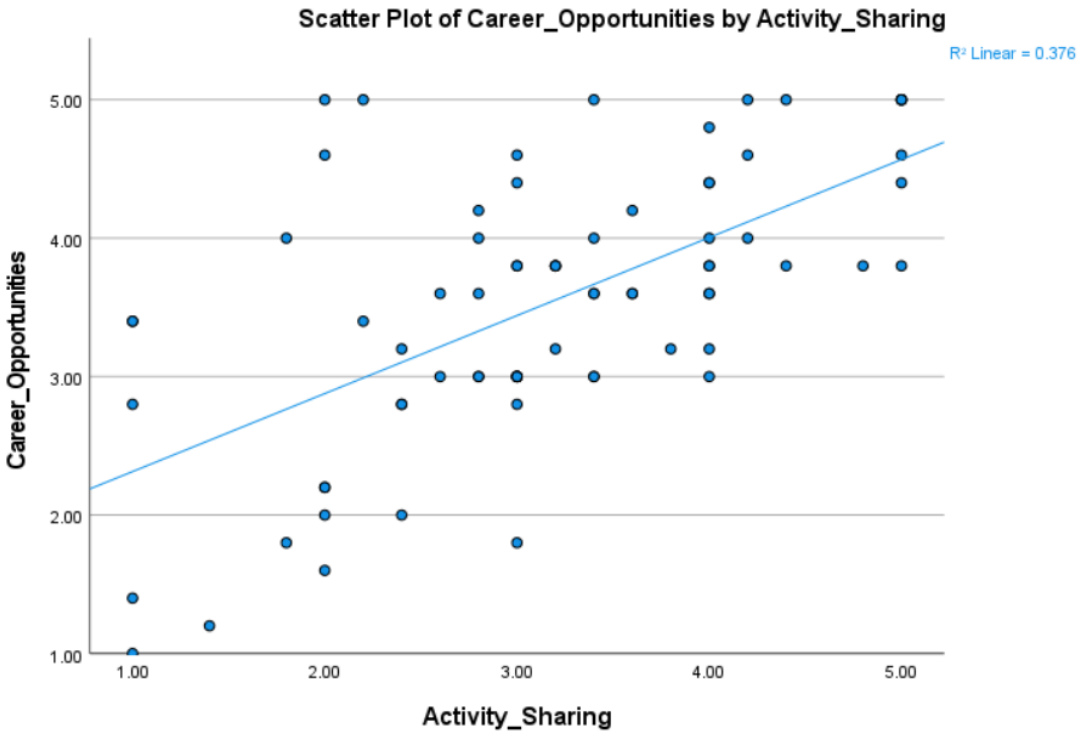


Figure B11. Scatterplot of Achievement and Activity Sharing and Perceived Career Opportunities.

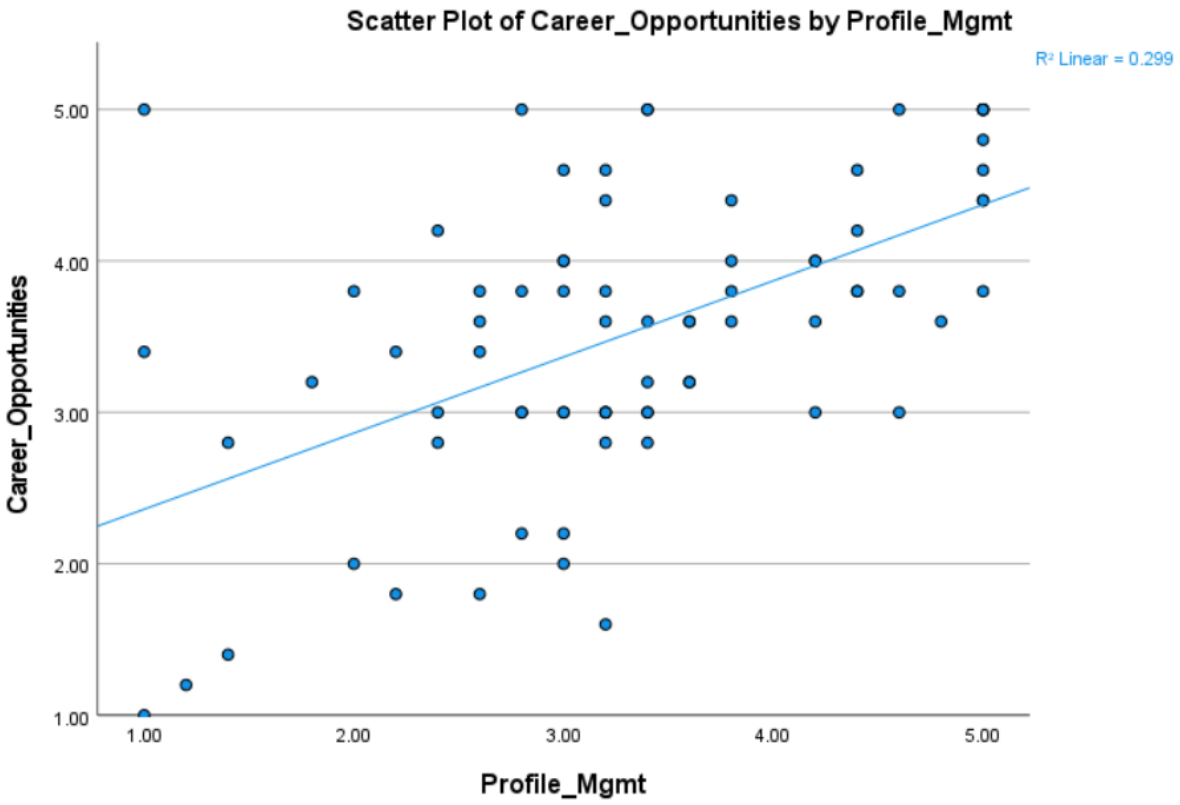


Figure B12. Scatterplot of Profile Management and Perceived Career Opportunities.

Table B7. Hypothesis summary based on Pearson correlations

Hypothesis	**Relationship tested**	**Pearson r with career opportunities**	**Conclusion**
H1	Profile management - perceived career opportunities	.547, $p < .001$	Supported as a positive correlation
H2	Achievement/activity sharing - perceived career opportunities	.614, $p < .001$	Supported as a positive correlation
H3	Professional networking - perceived career opportunities	.711, $p < .001$	Supported as a positive correlation
H4	Personal branding - perceived career opportunities	.757, $p < .001$	Supported as a positive correlation

These hypotheses are supported when we look at the correlation. In the regression model only professional networking and personal branding stand out as statistically significant unique predictors when all four dimensions are in play. These are questions and I do not think they should be called contradictory.

6.5 Multiple Regression Analysis

The regression model turned out to be statistically significant with F(4 71) equal to 29.423 and a p value below.001. The regression model explained sixty-two-point four percent of the observed variance in perceived career opportunity scores as shown by an R^2 of.624. Personal branding emerged as the positive predictor, with a beta of.581 and a p value below.001. Professional networking also proved significant with a beta of.328 and a p value of.006. However profile management and achievement/activity sharing did not become predictors once the other dimensions were added. That does not mean that profile management and achievement/activity sharing are useless; their effects may overlap with variables in the model.

Table B4. Multiple regression predicting perceived career opportunities

Predictor	Standardized β	t	p
Profile management	.019	.158	.875
Achievement and activity sharing	-.098	-.638	.525
Professional networking	.328	2.849	.006
Personal branding	.581	3.804	< .001

Model fit: R = .790; R^2 = .624; adjusted R^2 = .603; F(4, 71) = 29.423, p < .001.

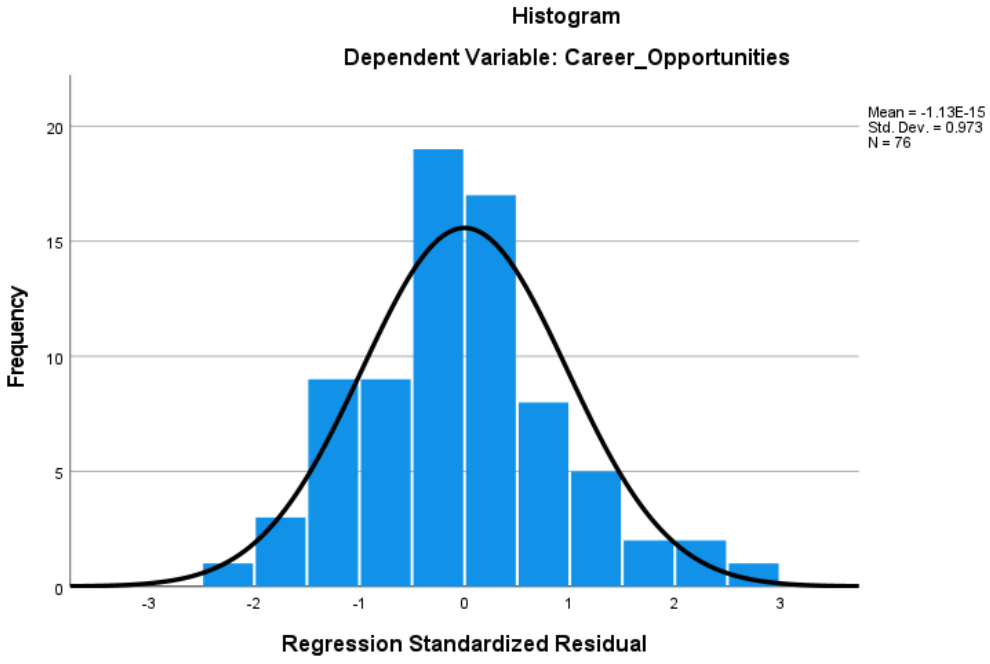


Figure B7. Histogram of standardized regression residuals for Career Opportunities.

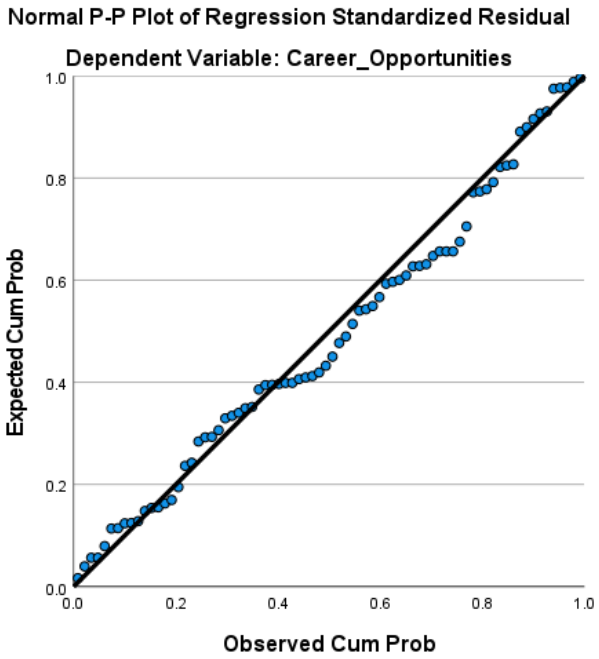


Figure B8. Normal P–P plot of regression standardized residuals for Career Opportunities.

6.6 One-Way ANOVA

The one-way ANOVA did not show a significant difference in perceived career opportunity scores, among the groups based on LinkedIn use frequency, F(4, 71) = 1.836, p =.131. The sample data does not provide evidence at the.05 level to conclude that the group means are different. That does not mean frequency can never matter. It just means this data does not support a connection.

Table B5. One-way ANOVA by LinkedIn-use frequency

Source	Sum of squares	df	Mean square	F	p
Between groups	6.723	4	1.681	1.836	.131
Within groups	65.001	71	.916		
Total	71.724	75			

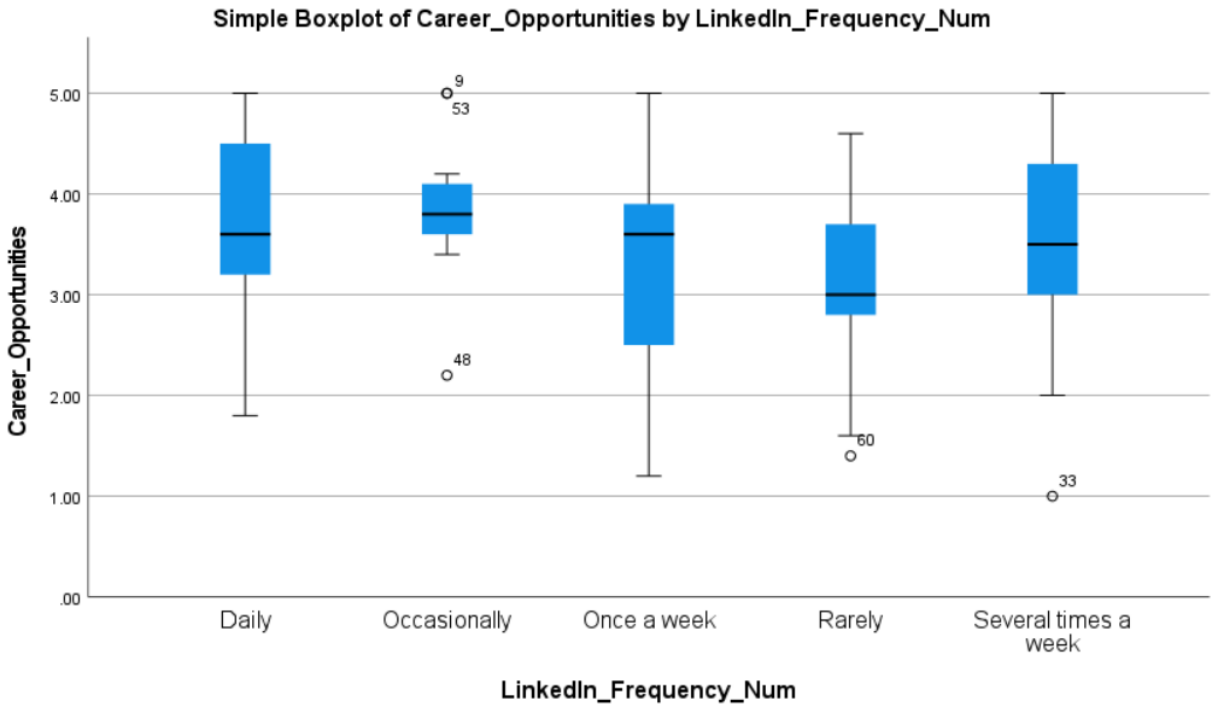


Figure B13. Boxplot of Perceived Career Opportunities by LinkedIn Usage Frequency.

6.7 Chi-Square Analysis

The Pearson chi-square result was chi square 8 equals thirteen point five four eight p equals point zero nine four which's not statistically significant at the five percent level. However sixty percent of expected cell counts were below five with a minimum expected count of point eight three so the usual chi square approximation may be unreliable, for this table. The likelihood ratio test reported p equals point zero four six. Sparse expected counts still require caution. No firm association claim should be based on this test. This limitation applies to the selected chi analysis and does not invalidate the separate descriptive, reliability, correlation, regression or ANOVA results.

Table B6. Selected chi-square test

Test	Value	df	p
Pearson chi-square	13.548	8	.094
Likelihood ratio	15.759	8	.046

There were 9 cells and 60.0% of them had expected counts below 5. The smallest expected count was.83. Since the expected-count assumption is not met well, look at this test carefully. Do not use the likelihood-ratio p-value as evidence.

7. DISCUSSION

The results show that personal branding and professional networking were the clear-cut factors linked to how people saw their career opportunities in this group. Both of these were connected to the outcome and stayed important in the analysis when all four factors were looked at together. These results suggest that LinkedIn could help with career growth but using it well might need participation and support.

Personal branding might be important because it lets students show their interests, strengths and growing skills in a way. Networking might be important because having the right professional connections can help students find out about jobs, companies and career paths. These are ways to understand the links we saw but they are not proven causes.

Profile management and sharing achievements were also linked to how people saw their career opportunities. They didn't stand out as unique predictors once the other factors were considered. Their effect might be similar to branding and networking. This doesn't mean that profile quality or sharing achievements isn't important. It just means the model didn't find a separate effect for these areas.

The ANOVA didn't find any differences between groups based on how often people used LinkedIn. This suggests that just using it often didn't make a big difference in how people saw their career opportunities. The chi-square test had few expected counts so it's not reliable enough to say there is a real link. It should be seen as uncertain, not as proof of a relationship.

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

8.1 For IT Undergraduates

- Build a clear profile that shows real skills, real projects, real interests and real qualifications.
- Make professional connections and talk in a thoughtful way instead of just trying to have a lot of connections.
- Show some technical projects with explanations, including what the problem was, what you did, what tools you used and what you learned.
- Make sure the information on your profile is always current and don't say you can do things you can't.
- Use LinkedIn with learning technical stuff building a portfolio, getting work experience preparing for interviews and applying for jobs that fit.

8.2 For Universities

- Offer practical workshops on profile writing, professional communication, and networking.
- Help students describe coursework and group projects accurately in professional portfolios.
- Create opportunities to meet alumni and industry professionals through mentoring and networking events.

- Provide guidance on privacy, respectful online engagement, and authentic self-presentation.

9. LIMITATIONS

- The study uses seventy six responses that were collected by convenience sampling and peer sharing. This means the sample may not represent all IT undergraduates in Sri Lanka.
- Cross-sectional design only measures responses at one point in time. It cannot establish cause and effect.
- Dependent variable measures perceived career opportunities of verified job offers, internships or employment outcomes.
- Independent variables overlap, which can affect estimates of their regression contributions.
- The chi-square test has sparse expected cell counts making the conventional approximation unreliable for a conclusion.
- Analysis depends on self-reported survey responses, which may be affected by differences in interpretation or response style.

10. CONCLUSION

This study looked at how IT undergraduates use LinkedIn and how that use relates to their achievements, networking, personal branding and how they view their career chances. The analysis used 76 survey responses. Applied descriptive statistics, reliability analysis, Pearson correlation, multiple linear regression, one-way ANOVA and a chi-square test. The results give a picture of how the surveyed students see their professional use of LinkedIn although the findings are limited to this sample and the measures used.

All four professionalism aspects are linked to career chances. Personal branding shows the link and is the strongest predictor in the regression model. Professional networking also helps a lot. Profile care and sharing achievements connect to career chances. Do not add extra power when the other aspects are counted. This suggests that students should show a professional identity and build useful contacts while keeping profiles neat and sharing real successes.

In short, LinkedIn can help students be seen and make connections. It cannot replace learning tech skills, doing projects, gaining experience and preparing for a career. Because the study only looks at a moment it cannot prove that LinkedIn habits cause job success.